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Leader on the prowl

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The Indian Super League (ISL) has been dominated by two teams in the last two seasons, Mohun Bagan Super Giant and Mumbai City.

Both clubs have won the League Shield and the ISL Cup once each. However, their neck-to-neck competition took a rather anti-climactic turn at the beginning of 2025.

Under new head coach, Jose Molina, the Mariners (**above**) remain at the top of the standings, with a league double over arch-rival East Bengal. However, Petr Kratky's men, though in the top six, remain clear of challenging for the shield so far.

Meanwhile, Punjab, which started as an underdog and led the table for some time, has

failed to win a game this year, while Jamshedpur, another underdog, has climbed to a potential knockout spot with seven more games to play.

Mohammedan Sporting, on the other hand, has remained in choppy waters, both on and off the field. The club has been embroiled in a severe financial crisis, with two key investors, BunkerHill Pvt. Ltd. and Shrachi Sports, unhappy about not getting the required shares of the club and have threatened to not put any further money into the club.

"We too, have not been issued any shares by the club despite repeated promises to do so," Shrachi said in a media release.

"BunkerHill, despite investing into the club for the last three years, has not been issued any